

NHS OUTLOOK

What the next monthly releases are expected to show

Across 8 headline measures, the next-release outlook is 3 improving, 1 broadly stable, 4 deteriorating. 6 of 8 measures remain off course against their medium-term milestones.

07 October 2026

8 indicators

Release months differ by measure; each row is dated.

INDICATOR	LATEST	OUTLOOK	ACTUAL
URGENT CARE			
A&E four-hour performance 95% constitutional standard 12 favourable · 22 adverse provider signals	75.0% Aug 2026 Baseline when outlook was made	75.9% Sep 2026 · Improvement expected 80% range 74.0%–77.7%	— Not yet released Added in the outturn edition
Category 2 ambulance response 18-minute standard 0 favourable · 2 adverse provider signals	28.9 min Aug 2026 Baseline when outlook was made	30.9 min Sep 2026 · Deterioration expected 80% range 24.2 min–36.1 min	— Not yet released Added in the outturn edition
PLANNED CARE			
RTT within 18 weeks 92% constitutional standard 81 favourable · 12 adverse provider signals	65.4% Jul 2026 Baseline when outlook was made	64.7% Aug 2026 · Deterioration expected 80% range 63.5%–66.0%	— Not yet released Added in the outturn edition
Diagnostics waiting over six weeks 1% operational standard 42 favourable · 40 adverse provider signals	23.1% Jul 2026 Baseline when outlook was made	25.2% Aug 2026 · Deterioration expected 80% range 22.7%–27.2%	— Not yet released Added in the outturn edition
Cancer treatment within 62 days 85% constitutional standard 27 favourable · 19 adverse provider signals	71.2% Jul 2026 Baseline when outlook was made	70.7% Aug 2026 · Broadly stable 80% range 68.9%–72.3%	— Not yet released Added in the outturn edition
COMMUNITY			
Two-hour urgent community response 70% national standard 13 favourable · 5 adverse provider signals	85.3% Aug 2026 Baseline when outlook was made	86.1% Aug 2026 · Improvement expected 80% range 85.6%–86.9%	— Not yet released Added in the outturn edition
Community waiting list within 18 weeks 80% by March 2029 10 favourable · 10 adverse provider signals	75.9% Jul 2026 Baseline when outlook was made	75.3% Aug 2026 · Deterioration expected 80% range 74.2%–76.3%	— Not yet released Added in the outturn edition
MENTAL HEALTH			
Talking Therapies within six weeks 75% national standard Provider trajectory watch not available	83.8% Jul 2026 Baseline when outlook was made	85.2% Aug 2026 · Improvement expected 80% range 83.4%–86.7%	— Not yet released Added in the outturn edition

How to read this. Outlooks are one-month-ahead forecasts made only with information available before release. The 80% range reflects historic one-step forecast errors. Provider signals compare six successive releases with the forecasts archived before each release; they are prompts for review, not rankings.

Sources. NHS England A&E attendances and emergency admissions · NHS England Ambulance Quality Indicators · NHS England referral to treatment waiting times · NHS England diagnostic waiting times and activity · NHS England cancer waiting times · NHS England two-hour urgent community response · NHS England community health services waiting lists · NHS Talking Therapies monthly statistics. Planning milestones and standards are cited in each indicator deep dive.